

UNIT 5 · TOPIC 5.3

New Distribution Capability (NDC)

Airlines take control of what they sell — and how.



B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 5: Technology & Trends
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TOPIC 5.3

Mission Video Briefing



Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 5: Technology & Trends · Topic 5.3

TOPIC 5.3

Mission Question



THINK ABOUT IT

Why do airlines want to control exactly how their tickets are sold?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



TOPIC 5.3

Mission Briefing

1

5.3.1

Introduction to NDC and its goals

2

5.3.2

Benefits for airlines, agents and customers

3

5.3.3

Impact on pricing, content distribution and personalisation

4

5.3.4

NDC standards and industry adoption

**MISSION OBJECTIVES**

- Explain what NDC is and why it exists
- Assess benefits for each stakeholder
- Describe NDC's effect on offers
- Investigate adoption status

Pedagogy: Inquiry-Based Learning

TOPIC 5.3.1

What Is NDC?

**XML/API standard**

Launched by IATA (Resolution 787, 2012) for airline-seller communication.

**Rich offers**

Bundles, ancillaries, photos, seat details, personalised prices.

**Airline retailing**

Airlines create offers themselves instead of relying only on filed fares.

**GOAL**

Let airlines sell through agents the same rich, personalised products they sell on their own websites.



TOPIC 5.3.1

Traditional vs NDC Distribution



Traditional (EDIFACT)

- Fares filed via ATPCO
- GDS builds the price
- Limited ancillaries
- Text-only content

VS

NDC

- Airline builds the offer
- Real-time, dynamic prices
- Full bundles and extras
- Rich media content



TOPIC 5.3.2

Benefits by Stakeholder



Airlines

Control of offers, lower distribution cost, upsell ancillaries.



Agents

Access to airline-exclusive fares and full product details.



Customers

Transparent comparison, personalised offers.

TOPIC 5.3.2

Challenges Agents Report

**Servicing**

Changes/refunds on NDC bookings can be harder.

**Fragmentation**

Each airline's API differs.

**Interline**

Multi-airline NDC itineraries still limited.

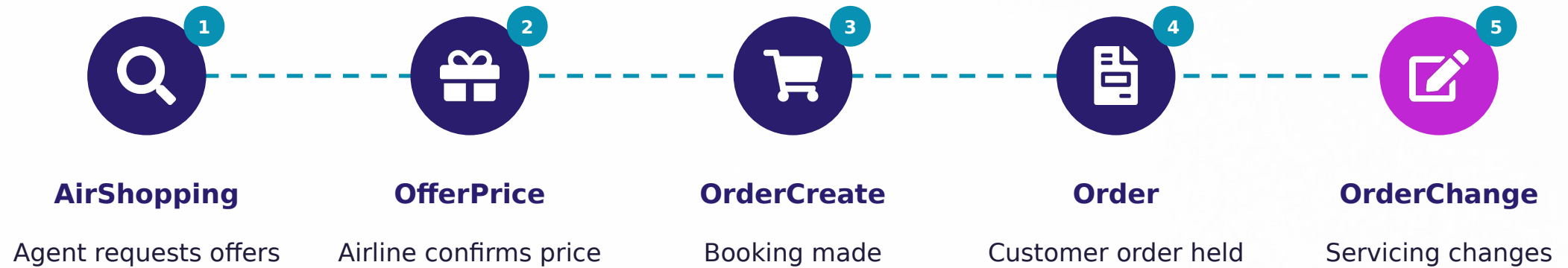
**Training**

New workflows to learn.



TOPIC 5.3.3

NDC Offer & Order Flow



TOPIC 5.3.3

Impact on Pricing & Personalisation

**Continuous pricing**

Not limited to 26 booking-class buckets.

**Personal offers**

Can reflect loyalty status or corporate profile.

**Rich content**

Seat photos, cabin videos, clear inclusions.

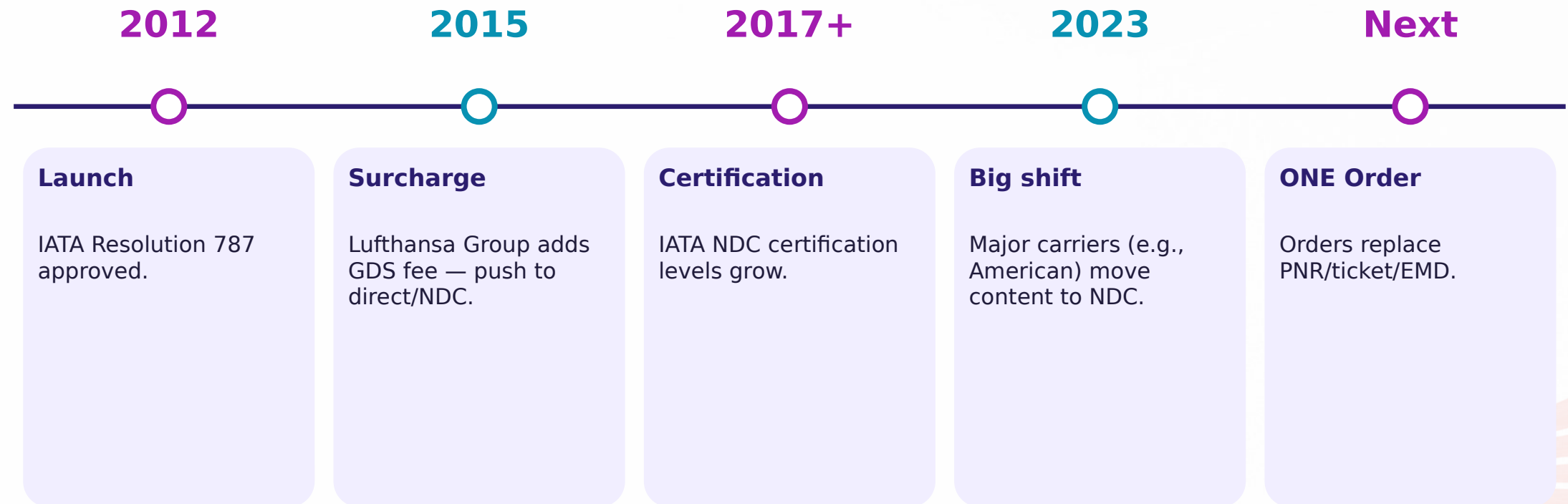
**INQUIRY**

Is it fair if two people see different prices for the same seat? Research how airlines explain personalised pricing.



TOPIC 5.3.4

NDC Adoption Milestones



TOPIC 5.3.4

Adoption Snapshot (Approx.)

100s

airlines and IT providers NDC-certified

GDSnow distribute NDC content alongside
EDIFACT**India**

growing NDC use by Indian agents



Verify current numbers on the IATA NDC page before class.



TOPIC 5.3

Innovation Lab: NDC Investigation

**PEDAGOGY****Inquiry-Based Learning****TIME · 12 min****FORMAT · Groups of 3****1**

Pick one airline and research its NDC programme online.

2

Find: channel options, any GDS surcharge, NDC-exclusive offers.

3

List two benefits and two challenges for Indian agents.

4

Present findings with sources.



TOPIC 5.3*Click to reveal each answer*

System Check Quiz

Q1**NDC was launched by...**

- A) ATPCO
- B) IATA
- C) DGCA
- D) Sabre

ANSWER**B****Q2****NDC is based on...**

- A) Paper forms
- B) XML/API messages
- C) Fax
- D) Telex only

ANSWER**B****Q3****Which NDC message creates a booking?**

- A) AirShopping
- B) OfferPrice
- C) OrderCreate
- D) SeatMap

ANSWER**C****Q4****A key airline benefit of NDC is...**

- A) Less control
- B) Richer, personalised offers
- C) More paper
- D) Fewer ancillaries

ANSWER**B**

MISSION COMPLETE

Key Takeaways

- ✓ NDC: IATA XML/API standard for airline retailing
- ✓ Airlines build offers; agents get richer content
- ✓ Enables dynamic, personalised pricing
- ✓ Adoption growing; ONE Order is next

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT MISSION

Topic 5.4 — Blockchain in Air Ticketing

Thank you · Questions?